

# Combine animal and plant protein foods in daily diet

When we think of protein foods, what usually come to mind are chicken, egg, fish, and meat. Many of us primarily consume animal protein foods daily. But, have you ever heard of plant protein? Some may not be aware that foods like tempeh, tofu, beans, legumes are also rich in protein—they're plant-based protein sources! Did you know that combining animal and plant protein foods gives a more nutritious diet?

## Why is protein important for your body?

Protein is needed in the forming of new cells and repairing of old cells in our body. It is involved in the growth and maintenance of the human body. It is also important in the formation of enzymes and hormones.

## Recommendations of daily protein intake

According to the Malaysian Dietary Guidelines 2020:



Fish:  
1 serving



Poultry/meat/eggs:  
1-2 servings



Legumes:  
1 serving

## Know your sources of protein

### Animal Protein

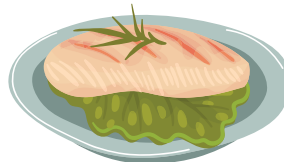
#### Fish and shellfish

- Good sources of protein, contain less saturated fat than meat and poultry
- **Fish:** salmon & herring - high in omega-3-fatty acid
- **Shellfish:** crabs, lobster, oysters, shrimps - low in saturated fat & low in calories



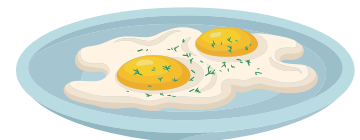
#### Meat and poultry

- Complete protein, containing all essential amino acids
- e.g. chicken or turkey breast, beef or pork tenderloin



#### Eggs

- Complete protein, containing all essential amino acids
- **Egg yolk:** a rich source of many vitamins and minerals



### Plant Protein

#### Legumes

- Low in fat (e.g. soya beans, red beans, chickpeas, green beans), high in dietary fibre, free from saturated fats & no cholesterol
- Contain phytonutrients



#### Nuts

- Contain unsaturated fatty acids & phytonutrients
- e.g. walnuts, pine nuts, almonds

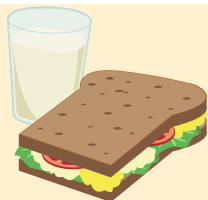


#### Soya bean foods

- Rich in protein, dietary fibre, unsaturated fat, vitamins & minerals
- e.g. tofu, soya bean milk, soya bean curd, tempeh



# Ideas to combine animal and plant proteins into your meal



## Breakfast

Soya bean milk with wholegrain egg sandwich



## Lunch

Add chickpeas to beef stew



## Dinner

Stir-fry shrimp with tofu

## Tips to cooking and consuming protein foods

The ways you cook and consume protein foods are very important in order for your body to get all the essential nutrients needed and avoiding any excessive intake:



Use healthier cooking methods such as steaming, stewing, braising, boiling, poaching, microwaving, grilling, roasting and air frying

Limit deep-frying methods as deep-frying adds fat and calories to these dishes



Limit breading and battering as these will cause the food to soak up more oil during frying, therefore, adding more fat and calories

Choose lean cuts of meat and poultry to minimise the intake of saturated fat



Choose skinless chicken parts before cooking

Limit the intake of organ meats such as liver and kidney



Consume nuts in small amounts (on a weekly basis) because they are high in calories

**Try this recipe with both plant-based and animal proteins!**

## Braised beancurd



### Ingredients

350 g (2 pcs) soft beancurd, cut into 12 pieces (square)  
100 g prawn, remove shell  
60 g (3 tbsp) canned peas  
50 g (1/2) carrot, cut into small pieces  
10 g (2 pips) garlic  
10 g (1 tbsp) vegetable oil  
2 g pepper  
5 g (2 tsp) cornflour, mixed with 4 tbsp water  
salt to taste  
500 ml (2 cups) water

### Garnishing

Coriander leaves and spring onion

### Method

1. Heat oil and fry garlic until golden brown.
2. Add in prawns and stir-fry for a while.
3. Add in water, carrot and allow to simmer until half cooked.
4. Add in peas, beancurd, salt and cornflour mixture. Stir.
5. To serve, sprinkle pepper and garnish with spring onion and coriander leaves.

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## MISSING MILK, MISSING NUTRIENTS

Only **3%**

of **adolescents**  
drink enough\*  
milk daily



\*2 glasses of 250 ml

Only **1%**

of **adults**  
drink enough\*  
milk daily

**NOT ENOUGH** milk intake contributed to



**Inadequate  
Calcium**

**98%** of adolescents

**96%** of adults

**Inadequate  
Phosphorus**

**67%** of adolescents

**38%** of adults

**Inadequate  
Vitamin B2**

**48%** of adolescents

**56%** of adults

Calcium & phosphorus  
are essential for



**strong bones and teeth**

Vitamin B2 is  
essential for



**energy metabolism**



"Consume at least 2 glasses of milk daily to ensure  
adequate intake of calcium, phosphorus & vitamin B2"